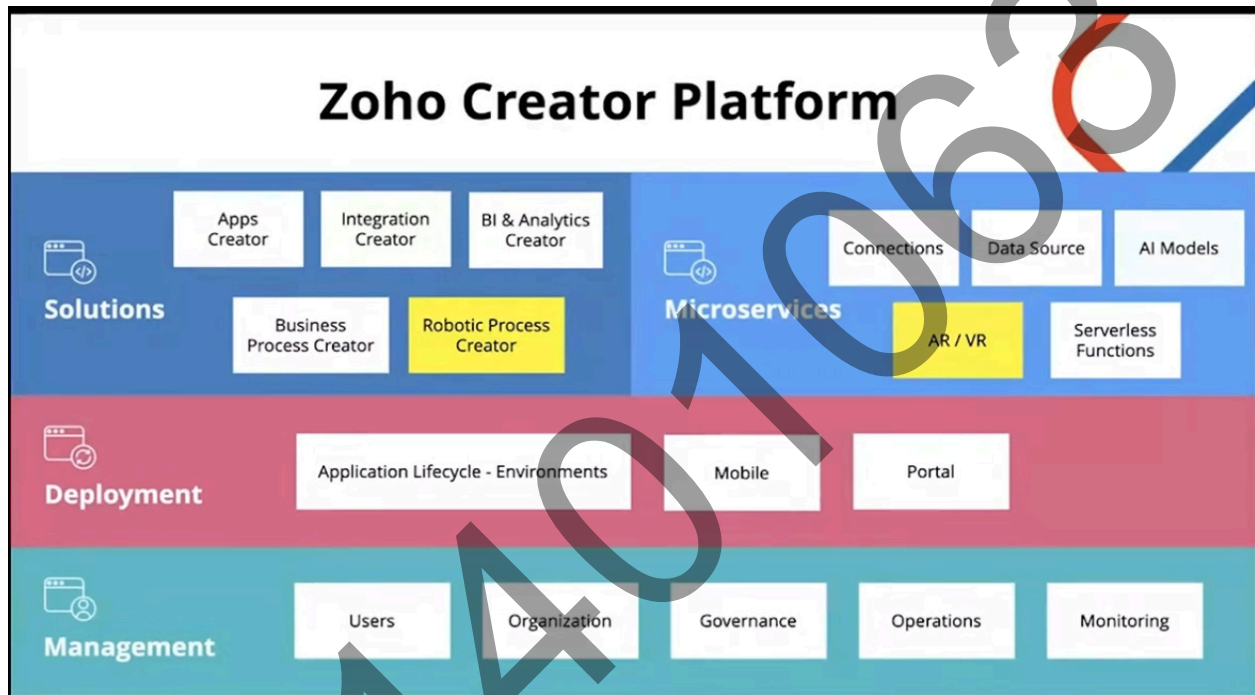


Exp no.2: Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

Pavitha M
241401063

Zoho Creator Architecture



1. Solutions Layer

The **Solutions** layer is responsible for designing and developing business applications. It provides various creators that help users build applications with minimal coding.

Apps Creator

- Used to develop complete business applications.
- Allows users to create forms, reports, dashboards, and workflows using drag-and-drop components.
- Forms the core application development environment.

Integration Creator

- Connects Zoho Creator applications with external systems and third-party services.
- Supports APIs, web services, and connectors for seamless data exchange.

BI & Analytics Creator

- Generates reports, dashboards, charts, and data visualizations.
- Helps organizations analyse business data and make informed decisions.

Business Process Creator

- Designs business workflows and automates approval processes.
- Defines process flows, task assignments, notifications, and business rules.

Robotic Process Creator (RPA)

- Automates repetitive manual tasks using software bots.
 - Reduces human effort and improves operational efficiency by automating routine business activities.
-

2. Microservices Layer

The **Microservices** layer extends application functionality by providing reusable services that can be integrated into multiple applications.

Connections

- Establishes secure connections with third-party applications.
- Enables communication with external APIs and cloud services.

Data Source

- Connects applications to external databases and enterprise systems.
- Allows applications to retrieve and update data from multiple sources.

AI Models

- Integrates Artificial Intelligence into applications.
- Supports prediction, classification, text analysis, and intelligent automation.

AR/VR

- Provides Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR) capabilities.
- Enables development of immersive business applications requiring 3D visualization.

Serverless Functions

- Executes backend logic without managing servers.
 - Allows developers to write custom functions that run automatically when triggered by events.
-

3. Deployment Layer

The **Deployment** layer is responsible for publishing and distributing applications.

Application Lifecycle – Environments

- Supports multiple environments such as Development, Testing, and Production.
- Enables controlled deployment and version management.

Mobile

- Automatically generates mobile-friendly versions of applications.
- Allows users to access applications from Android and iOS devices.

Portal

- Creates secure portals for customers, vendors, partners, or employees.
 - Provides controlled access to application data based on user roles.
-

4. Management Layer

The **Management** layer provides administrative and monitoring capabilities.

Users

- Manages user accounts, permissions, and roles.

Organization

- Configures organization-wide settings and policies.

Governance

- Implements security policies, compliance rules, and access control.

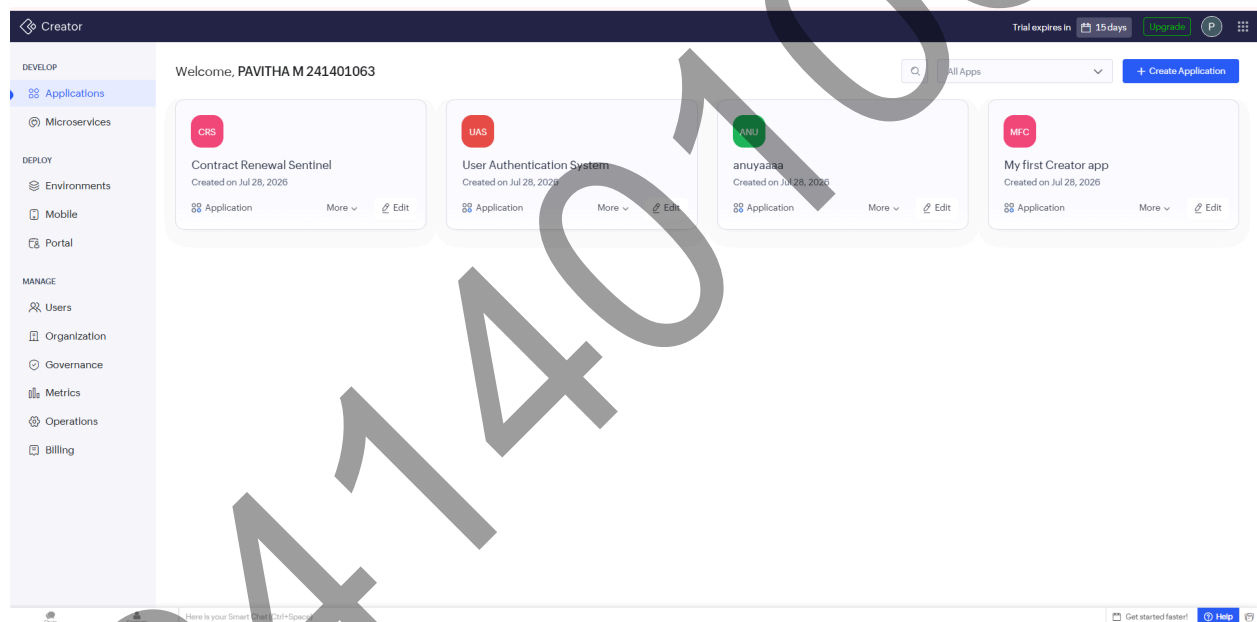
Operations

- Handles administrative tasks such as backups, maintenance, and application operations.

Monitoring

- Tracks application performance, usage statistics, and system health.
- Helps identify issues and improve application reliability.

Applications Dashboard



This dashboard serves as the central workspace where users can manage, access, and create low-code applications.

1. Navigation Panel (Left Sidebar)

The left sidebar provides access to the main modules of Zoho Creator:

- **Applications** – Displays all the applications created by the user.
- **Microservices** – Used to build and manage independent services for modular application development.

- **Environments** – Helps manage different deployment environments such as Development, Testing, and Production.
- **Mobile** – Allows users to configure and manage mobile versions of applications.
- **Portal** – Enables the creation of customer or partner portals for external users.
- **Users** – Manage user accounts, roles, and permissions.
- **Organization** – Configure organization-level settings.
- **Governance** – Monitor security policies and access control.
- **Metrics** – View analytics and performance statistics of applications.
- **Operations** – Perform administrative and maintenance tasks.
- **Billing** – Manage subscription plans, payments, and usage details.

2. Welcome Section

At the top of the dashboard, the user is greeted with a welcome message displaying the account name. This confirms the logged-in user and provides quick access to their workspace.

3. Application Cards

The center of the dashboard displays all the applications created by the user as individual cards. Each application card includes:

- **Application icon** for easy identification.
- **Application name** (e.g., *Contract Renewal Sentinel*, *User Authentication System*).
- **Creation date** indicating when the application was created.
- **Application type** showing that it is a Creator application.
- **More** menu for additional actions such as sharing, duplicating, exporting, or deleting.
- **Edit** option to open the application in the builder for modification.

4. Search and Filter

The top-right section contains:

- A **Search** icon to quickly locate an application.
- An **All Apps** dropdown to filter applications by category or type.

5. Create Application Button

The **+ Create Application** button allows users to start building a new application. Selecting this option opens the application creation screen, where users can choose to create an app from scratch, use AI (Zia), select a template, or import existing data.

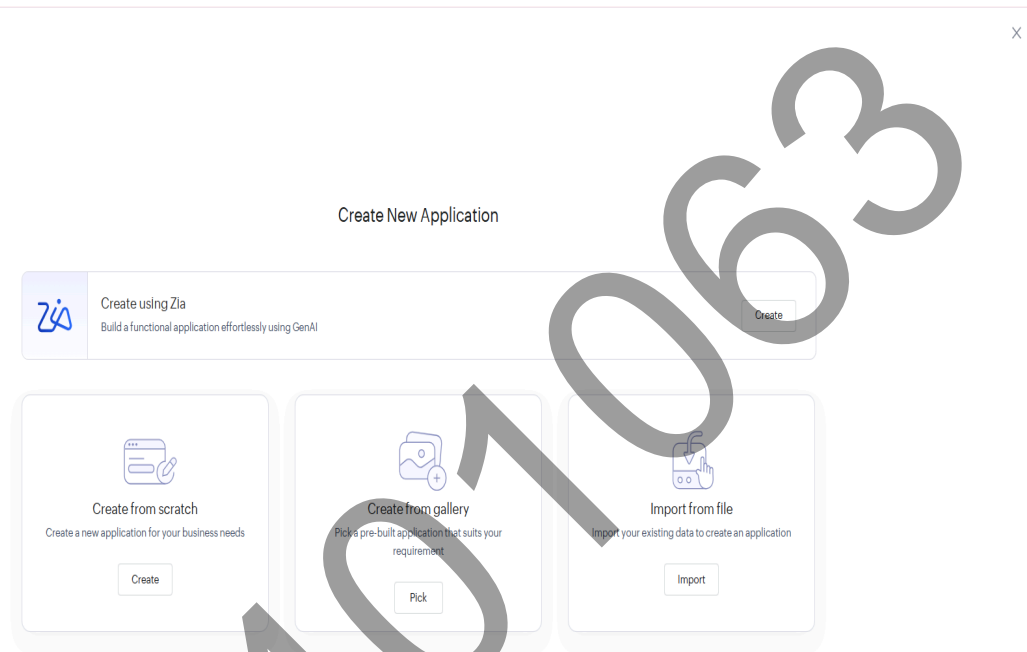
6. Top Navigation Bar

The top navigation bar displays:

- Trial subscription status and remaining trial period.

- **Upgrade** option to switch to a paid plan.
- User profile icon for account settings.
- Application launcher/menu for accessing other Zoho services.

Create New Application Screen



1. Create using Zia (AI-Based Development)

- This option uses **Zia**, an AI-powered assistant, to automatically generate a functional application.
- Users describe their application requirements in natural language, and the AI creates the initial structure, forms, and workflows.
- This method reduces development time and is suitable for quickly building applications with minimal manual effort.

2. Create from Scratch

- This option allows users to build an application from the beginning.
- Users can design their own database, forms, reports, workflows, and user interface according to their business needs.

- It provides complete flexibility and customization.

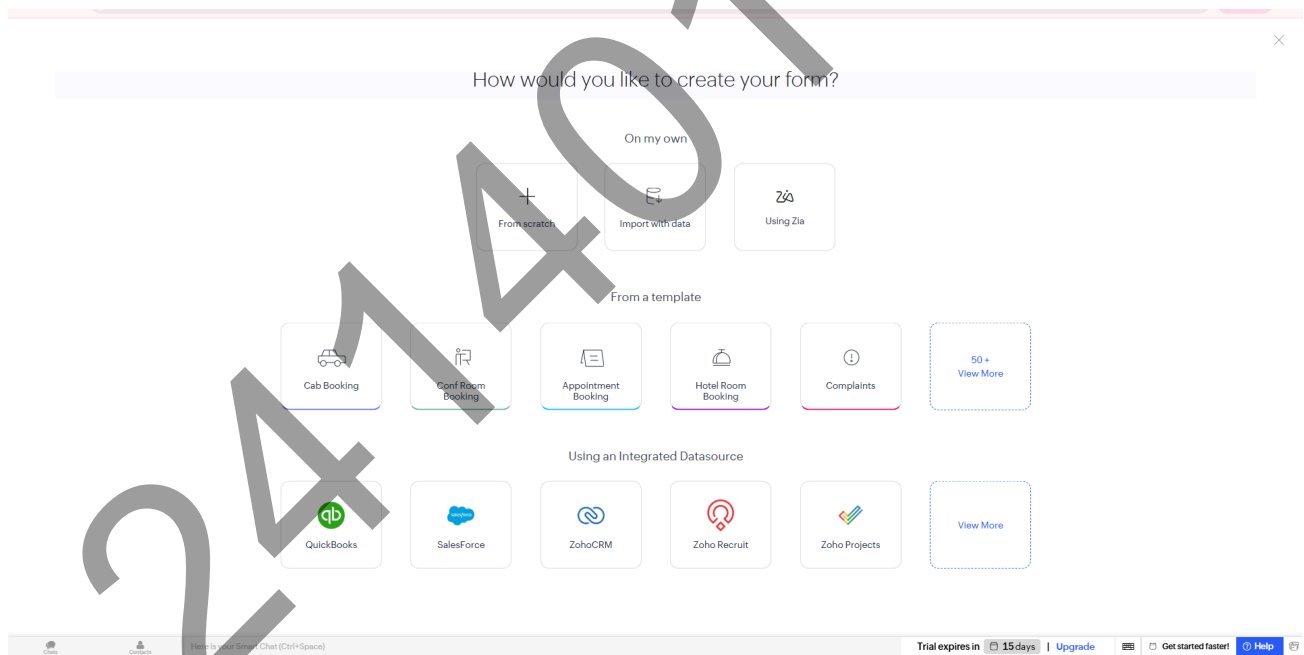
3. Create from Gallery

- This option provides access to a collection of pre-built application templates.
- Users can select a template that closely matches their requirements and customize it instead of building the application from scratch.
- This approach saves time and follows industry best practices.

4. Import from File

- This option allows users to create an application by importing existing data from files such as Excel or CSV.
- The platform automatically generates forms and data structures based on the imported data.
- It is useful for migrating existing records into a new application.

Create Form Screen



1. Create a Form on Your Own

This section provides three methods for creating a custom form:

- **From Scratch**

- Allows users to design a form manually by adding fields such as text boxes, number fields, date pickers, drop-down lists, and other input components.
- Suitable when a completely customized form is required.
- **Import with Data**
 - Creates a form by importing data from external files such as Excel or CSV.
 - Zoho Creator automatically generates the required fields based on the imported data structure, reducing manual effort.
- **Using Zia**
 - Uses **Zia**, Zoho's AI assistant, to generate a form automatically based on the user's description.
 - Users simply describe the purpose of the form, and Zia creates the initial form structure with appropriate fields.

2. Create from a Template

This section provides ready-made templates for commonly used business applications. Users can select a template and customize it instead of designing a form from scratch. Some available templates include:

- **Cab Booking** – Used to manage cab reservations and transportation requests.
- **Conference Room Booking** – Helps schedule and manage meeting room reservations.
- **Appointment Booking** – Used for scheduling customer or client appointments.
- **Hotel Room Booking** – Manages hotel room reservations and guest details.
- **Complaints** – Records and tracks customer or employee complaints.
- **View More (50+)** – Provides access to over 50 additional pre-built templates for different business scenarios.

Using templates significantly reduces development time since the basic form structure and workflow are already available.

3. Using an Integrated Datasource

This section allows users to create forms by connecting to external business applications and databases. Supported integrations include:

- **QuickBooks** – Import and manage accounting and financial records.
- **Salesforce** – Access customer relationship management (CRM) data.
- **Zoho CRM** – Create forms connected to CRM modules such as Leads and Contacts.
- **Zoho Recruit** – Manage recruitment and candidate information.
- **Zoho Projects** – Integrate project management data.
- **View More** – Displays additional supported data source integrations.

These integrations enable seamless synchronization of data between Zoho Creator and external applications.

Form Builder Interface

The screenshot shows a form builder interface for a 'Book a Cab' application. The interface is divided into three main sections: a 'Basic Fields' sidebar on the left, a central workspace for the form, and a 'Field Properties' panel on the right. The 'Basic Fields' sidebar contains icons for various field types: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox. The central workspace displays a form with the following fields: Name (with a red asterisk), Employee ID (with a red asterisk), Email Id (with a red asterisk), Mobile Number (with a red asterisk), Gender (with a red asterisk), Booking Date (with a red asterisk), Travel Date (with a red asterisk), Pickup Time (with a red asterisk), Pickup Address (with a red asterisk), and Destination Address (with a red asterisk). The 'Field Properties' panel on the right shows settings for the selected 'Name' field, including Field name, Field link name, Validation (Mandatory), Display Fields (Prefix, First Name, Last Name, Suffix), Data Privacy (Contains personal data), Data Security (Data encryption is not supported), and Visibility (Show field to).

1. Form Builder Workspace

The center section displays the form being designed. It contains various fields that users will fill in while submitting a cab booking request. The fields include:

- **Name** – Captures the user's full name.
- **Employee ID** – Stores the employee identification number.
- **Email ID** – Records the user's email address.
- **Mobile Number** – Collects the contact number.
- **Gender** – Allows the user to select their gender.
- **Booking Date** – Specifies the date on which the booking is made.
- **Travel Date** – Records the scheduled travel date.
- **Pickup Time** – Captures the preferred pickup time.
- **Pickup Address** – Stores the starting location.
- **Destination Address** – Stores the destination location.

The red asterisk (*) beside each field indicates that the field is **mandatory**.

2. Basic Fields Panel (Left Sidebar)

The left panel contains a collection of form fields that can be dragged and dropped into the form. Some commonly used field types include:

- Name
- Email

- Address
- Phone
- Single Line Text
- Multi Line Text
- Number
- Date
- Time
- Drop-down List
- Radio Button
- Multi Select
- Checkbox

These field types enable users to design forms according to different data collection requirements.

3. Field Properties Panel (Right Sidebar)

The right panel displays the properties of the currently selected field (in this case, the **Name** field). It allows users to configure various settings such as:

- **Field Name** – Defines the display name shown on the form.
- **Field Link Name** – Specifies the internal name used within the application.
- **Validation** – Marks the field as mandatory or optional.
- **Display Fields** – Selects which components of the Name field (Prefix, First Name, Last Name, Suffix) are displayed.
- **Data Privacy** – Indicates whether the field contains personally identifiable information (PII).
- **Visibility and Security** – Controls field visibility and other security-related settings.

These options help customize the behavior and appearance of each form field.

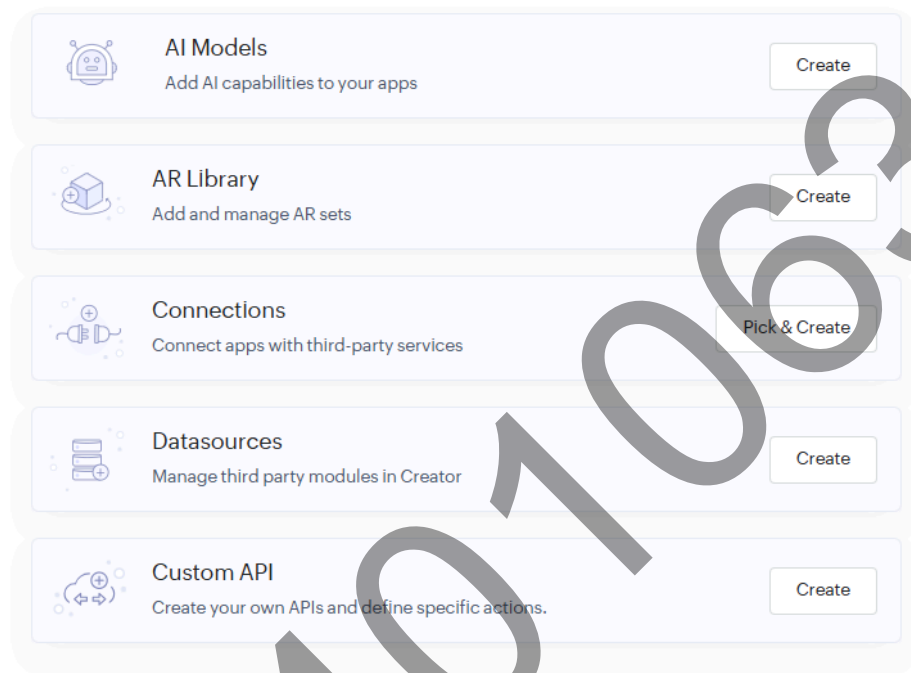
4. Top Navigation Bar

The top section provides controls for managing the form, including:

- Form name (**Book a Cab**).
- Options to add new components.
- Settings and additional configuration tools.
- **Done** button to save the form design and return to the application.

Create New Microservice Screen

Create New Microservice



1. AI Models

- The **AI Models** option allows users to integrate artificial intelligence capabilities into their applications.
- Users can create or configure AI models for tasks such as prediction, classification, text processing, and automation.
- This feature helps developers build intelligent applications with minimal coding.

2. AR Library

- The **AR Library** option is used to create and manage **Augmented Reality (AR)** resources.
- Users can add, organize, and maintain AR assets that can be integrated into applications.
- This feature is useful for applications requiring interactive 3D visualization or AR experiences.

3. Connections

- The **Connections** option enables applications to communicate with third-party services.
- It provides secure authentication and integration with external platforms such as cloud services, databases, payment gateways, and other business applications.
- Users can select an existing connection or create a new one using the **Pick & Create** option.

4. Datasources

- The **Datasources** option allows users to connect applications to external databases and third-party modules.
- It enables applications to retrieve, store, and synchronize data from different data sources without manual data entry.
- This helps ensure data consistency across multiple systems.

5. Custom API

- The **Custom API** option allows users to create their own APIs and define custom actions.
- These APIs can be used to exchange data between Zoho Creator and other applications.
- Custom APIs improve interoperability and support integration with external software and services.